

Some of you are still alive and playing in your Championship this week. Some of you completed their seasons last week or before. For those still alive, here is the news that you need to know:

General News:

Tampa Bay is expected to rest a lot of players in this game. They do not need the game and will likely sit Warrick Dunn. Brad Johnson and Keyshawn Johnson may play only a half. Doug Brien will also give Martin Gramatica another week to heal.

Pittsburgh will likely rest some of their players this week Jerome Bettis could start, but probably will not. Hines Ward and Kordell Stewart may only play a half. Don't expect Kordell to take off on many runs this week either.

Philadelphia is expected to rest the majority of their stars. Chad Lewis and James Thrash are not expected to play. Duce Staley may play. Donovan McNabb is likely to only to play a half.

The Rams will either be full throttle or resting their stars. If Chicago wins, expect Warner and Faulk to be huge. If Chicago loses, both could be spelled this week.

And now onto the individual players:

Quarterbacks in the News:

Chris Chandler (Atl) missed practice on Friday and isn't expected to play. He appears on the injury report as doubtful with a sore elbow. Michael Vick will start in his place.

Alex Van Pelt (Buf) was signed to a five-year contract extension.

Rob Johnson (Buf), who was just inched out of a Pro-Bowl selection, will not play this week. He is out with broken clavicle.

Tim Couch (Cle) was signed for another 4 years by the Browns.

Ty Detmer (Det) is expected to start for the injured Mike McMahon. Mike appears on the injury report as doubtful with a bad wheel.

Brett Favre (GB) practiced on Wednesday and Thursday and will start as usual. He appears on the injury report as probable with a sore side.

Trent Green (KC) practiced on Wednesday and Thursday and will start as usual with his sprained ankle. He appears on the injury report as probable with a sore ankle.

Jay Fiedler (Mia) practiced all week and will play with his sore elbow. He appears on the injury report as probable with a sore ankle.

Spergon Wynn (Min) will start for the injured Todd Bouman again this week.

Dante Culpepper (Min) is out this week with a bad knee.

Donovan McNabb (Phi) is not likely to play more than a half in this week's contest. The team will also be resting RB Duce Staley and WR James Thrash. The outcome of the game will not change their post-season seeding. They have won the NFC East. He appears on the injury report as probable with a sore wrist.

Doug Flutie (SD) is on a bye and will not play.

Trent Dilfer (Sea) will start in place of the injured Matt Hasselbeck this week. Matt appears on the injury report as questionable with a sore shoulder and bruised ego.

Brad Johnson (TB) is only expected to play about half of the football game.

Steve McNair (Ten) was excused from practice all week for health and personal issues. He is expected to start on Sunday as usual. He appears on the injury report as questionable with a sore back.

Running Backs in the News:

Bob Christian (Atl) appears on the injury report as probable with a sore foot/knee. He has practiced this week and will spell starter Maurice Smith.

Terry Allen (Bal) will start this week. Jason Brookins is expected to fill-in for him.

Travis Henry (Buf) was unable to practice on Thursday and is not expected to start this week. He appears on the injury report as probable with a sore knee. Shawn Bryson will start in his place.

Corey Dillon (Cin) is expected to play despite a sore hand.

James Stewart (Det) practiced on Thursday and Friday and could play this week. He is likely a gametime decision. He appears on the injury report as questionable with a twisted ankle. If he cannot go, look for Lamont Warren to start.

Warrick Dunn (TB) is not expected to play this week in a meaningless game. He appears on the injury report as doubtful with turf toe.

Dominic Rhodes (Ind) practiced on Thursday and is expected to start on Sunday despite his bad ankle. He appears on the injury report as probable.

Stacey Mack (Jac) will start for the injured Fred Taylor again this week. Fred appears on the injury report as questionable, but has not been cleared to play.

Priest Holmes (KC) practiced on Wednesday and Thursday and will start as usual this week.

Michael Bennett (Min) is expected to start despite a bruised foot. He appears on the injury report as probable.

Antowain Smith (NE) practiced this week despite a sore leg. He will start as usual. He appears on the injury report as probable.

Duce Staley (Phi) appears on the injured report as questionable with a sore shoulder. He is not expected to play a lot as the team heals it's stars before the playoffs. Correll Buckhalter will get plenty of carries in this game. Correll appears on the injury report as probable, but has practiced.

Amos Zereoue (Pit) was unable to practice on Thursday and could be a gametime decision. He appears on the injury report as questionable with a sore shoulder. Chris Fuamatu-Ma'afala is expected to start.

Jerome Bettis (Pit) practiced with first team on Wednesday so he will likely get some carries along with Chris Fuamatu-Ma'afala. Jerome appears on the injury report as questionable with a sore groin.

LaDainain Tomlinson (SD) is on a bye and will not play.

Warrick Dunn (TB) is not expected to play this week. Mike Alstott will shoulder the running duties this week. Aaron Stecker and Rabi Abdullah are also expected to get some carries.

Tough guy Mike Alstott (TB) has a sore thumb, but will start. He appears on the injury report as probable.

Stephen Davis (Was) practiced on Thursday and is expected to start. He appears on the injury report as questionable with a sore knee.

Wide Receivers in the News:

MarTay Jenkins (Ari) practiced on Wednesday and Thursday and will play on Sunday. David Boston and Frank Sanders will start as usual. MarTay appears on the injury report as questionable with a sprained ankle.

Tony Martin (Atl) was released by the Falcons this week. Shawn Jefferson and Brian Finneran remain the starters.

Brian Finneran (Atl) appears on the injury report as probable with a sore foot. He has practiced this week and is expected to start.

Shawn Jefferson (Atl) practiced this week and is expected to start. He appears on the injury report as probable with a sore knee.

Muhsin Muhammad (Car) is not expected to play this week.

Isaac Byrd (Car) will miss this week's game with a concussion. Donald Hayes and Patrick Jeffers are expected to start. Donald Hayes appears on the injury report as probable with a sore ankle.

Dez White (Chi) practiced on Thursday with his sore hamstring and is expected to play at least some of the game on Sunday. He appears on the injury report as questionable with a sore hamstring.

Darnay Scott (Cin) practiced all week and will start as expected despite his bruised shoulder. He appears on the injury report as probable.

Joey Galloway (Dal) practiced on Thursday and is expected to start on Sunday. He appears on the injury report as questionable with a pulled groin.

Rod Smith (Den) practiced this week and will start as usual. He is nursing two ankle sprains. He appears on the injury report as probable with a pair of sore ankles.

Kevin Kasper (Den) will play with sore ankle. He appears on the injury report as probable.

Bert Emanuel (Det) completed practice on Thursday and is expected to play. He appears on the injury report as probable with a sore knee.

Terrence Wilkins (Ind) missed practice on Thursday and is very questionable to play at receiver. He may return kicks. He appears on the injury report as questionable with a bad hamstring.

Oronde Gadsden (Mia), James McKnight and Chris Chambers all practiced on Thursday and are expected to play on Sunday despite various injuries. Oronde Gadsden appears on the injury report as questionable with a sore hamstring. James McKnight also appears as questionable with a bruised face. Chris Chambers is probable with an ankle injury.

Cris Carter (Min) has missed practice all week with a cracked rib. He is very questionable to play and will likely be a gametime decision. If he cannot go, Jake Reed will start opposite of Randy Moss.

Randy Moss (Min) hasn't done anything stupid this week?yet.

Terry Glenn (NE) was given Wednesday off for personal reasons. I am guessing he needs a lot more days off. Glenn practiced on Thursday and will play as the #3 WR this week.

Jerry Rice (Oak) is away from the team to be with his ailing father. It is unclear whether he will make it to the game on Sunday. If he does not play, Jerry Porter and James Jett would split time opposite of Tim Brown.

James Thrash (Phi) s not expected to play this week. He has a sprained ankle and appears on the injury report as doubtful.

Hines Ward (Pit) was able to practice on Thursday after missing on Wednesday. He appears on the injury report as probable with a tender ankle. He is expected to start as usual, but may only play about a half.

Curtis Conway and Jeff Graham (SD) are on a bye and will not play.

Koren Robinson (Sea) has been benched in favor of James Williams. James will start opposite of Darrell Jackson this week.

Keyshawn Johnson (TB) may be held out this week to get healthy for the playoffs. His status will likely not be known until gametime. He appears on the injury report as questionable with a bad ankle. If he does play, it will likely not be an entire game.

Reidell Anthony (TB) appears on the injury report as probable, but is expected to play.

Michael Westbrook (Was) was unable to practice on Thursday and may not be able to go on Sunday. He appears on the injury report as questionable with a sore ankle. Kevin Lockett would start in his place if he cannot go.

Tight Ends in the News:

Reggie Kelly (Atl) missed Friday's practice and does not look like he will play on Sunday. He appears on the injury report as doubtful with bruised ribs.

Shannon Sharpe (Bal) is expected to play despite a sore knee. He appears on the injury report as probable.

Wesley Walls (Car) is not expected to play this week. He has not practiced at all. Kris Magnum will start in his place.

Fred Baxter (Chi) was held out of practices this week with a sore knee. He will likely be a gametime decision despite being listed as probable on the latest injury report.

OJ Santiago (Cle) practiced and is expected to play. He appears on the injury report as probable with a sprained ankle.

Jackie Harris (Dal) practiced on Thursday despite having the flu. He is expected to start this week.

Patrick Hape (Den) missed practice on Thursday. He will be a gametime decision. He appears on the injury report as questionable with a sprained ankle.

Desmond Clark (Den) practiced this week and will start as expected. He appears on the injury report as probable with a sore groin.

Jason Dunn (KC) has been placed on the injured reserve list and is lost for the season.

Chad Lewis (Phi) is not expected to play after getting poked in the eye. He appears on the injury report as doubtful.

Freddie Jones (SD) is on a bye and will not play.

Eric Johnson (SF) missed practice on Wednesday and Thursday, but was hopeful to practice on Friday. He is still expected to start as usual. He appears on the injury report as probable with a sore foot.

Greg Clark (SF) is out again this week. He also is not expected to play in the playoffs either.

Dave Moore (TB) appears on the injury report as questionable with a thigh bruise. He is not likely to make a big contribution since the game means little to the Bucs.

Frank Wycheck (Ten) missed Thursday's practice, but is still expected to start on Sunday. He appears on the injury report as questionable with a thigh bruise.

Kickers in the News:

Sebastian Janikowski (Oak) is very questionable to play this week. He is suffering from a bad skin infection and has missed all practices this week. Recently signed Brad Daluiso is expected to be the Raider's kicker this week.

Doug Brien (TB) is expected to start in place of Martin Gramatica this week. Martin appears on the injury report as questionable with a bad hamstring.

Other News:

Steve Spurrier announced that he is resigning from his head coaching job at Florida to make himself available for the NFL.

Denny Green will be replaced as head coach of the Vikings starting this week. He will not coach the team on Monday night against the Ravens.

All beef patty, Tony Siragusa, will retire after this season to pursue a new career in broadcast journalism.

To unsubscribe from this group, send an email to:
cheatsheets-unsubscribe@egroups.com

Your use of Yahoo! Groups is subject to <http://docs.yahoo.com/info/terms/>